Pa o Kachatbingna Kasa wui Khararchan: The Acts of the Apostles

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Preface & Archival Information

Pa o Kachatbingna Kasa wui Khararchan: The Acts of the Apostles in Tangkhul Naga, translated by Rev. William Pettigrew. Published in London by the British and Foreign Bible Society, 1905; printed at the Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta. Details the day of Pentecost, Peter’s defense before the Sanhedrin, Stephen’s martyrdom, and Paul’s speech at the Areopagus in Athens.

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Chapter 1: Kazingli Kaphan kala Kachatbing (Ascension and Commission)

CHAPTER 1: KAZINGLI KAPHAN KALA KACHATBING (ASCENSION AND COMMISSION)

Summary: The ascension of Christ from the Mount of Olives and the gathering of the apostles in Jerusalem.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Theophilus-li kaphung kakhanin: Jesu-na khararchanli ot kasawui maram kaphung-kachungli kaphika thotsai. Awui thikahaiwui saphunga A haringkasa theichithei kachiva thotna athumli thang taracham kachithei Varivarawui kazingramwui tui hosa. Mangan Kathara nithumwui kachungli raranglikha nithum pangmashan phunglikha; kala Jerusalemli, Judea kala Samaria ram kachivali, kala ngalei pammai kashung kachivali Iwui sakhibing salikha. Athumna theishak phashokda Matthiasli rasai, kala aya kachatbing tarakhatli ngasohailsai.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

The former treatise have I made, O Theophilus, of all that Jesus began both to do and teach. To whom also he shewed himself alive after his passion by many infallible proofs, being seen of them forty days. But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth. And they gave forth their lots; and the lot fell upon Matthias; and he was numbered with the eleven apostles.

Chapter 1 (Continued)

CHAPTER 1: READING CONTINUATION (PAGE 5)

TANGKHUL TEXT (CONTINUED):

Theophilus-li kaphung kakhanin: Jesu-na khararchanli ot kasawui maram kaphung-kachungli kaphika thotsai. Awui thikahaiwui saphunga A haringkasa theichithei kachiva thotna athumli thang taracham kachithei Varivarawui kazingramwui tui hosa. Mangan Kathara nithumwui kachungli raranglikha nithum pangmashan phunglikha; kala Jerusalemli, Judea kala Samaria ram kachivali, kala ngalei pammai kashung kachivali Iwui sakhibing salikha. Athumna theishak phashokda Matthiasli rasai, kala aya kachatbing tarakhatli ngasohailsai.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION (CONTINUED):

The former treatise have I made, O Theophilus, of all that Jesus began both to do and teach. To whom also he shewed himself alive after his passion by many infallible proofs, being seen of them forty days. But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth. And they gave forth their lots; and the lot fell upon Matthias; and he was numbered with the eleven apostles.

Chapter 1 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 1 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* Kachatbing (noun plural): apostles, authoritative emissaries
* Pangmashan (noun): power, divine might, spiritual authority
* Sakhibing (noun plural): witnesses, testifiers to truth
* Theishak (noun): lots, divine casting of decision

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Tangkhul uses the indigenous legal term 'sakhibing' (witnesses) for those testifying under solemn oath.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? How long was Jesus seen by the apostles after His passion?

? Who was chosen to take the place of Judas among the twelve?

Chapter 2: Pentecost Thangli Mangan Kathara (Day of Pentecost)

CHAPTER 2: PENTECOST THANGLI MANGAN KATHARA (DAY OF PENTECOST)

Summary: The descent of the Holy Spirit like rushing wind and tongues of fire, and Peter’s first sermon.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Pentecost kumshang phungphatli nithum pam akhangli zikahai pamsai. Kazingwui huchiphung majung katha khara rasai, kala athum pamsahai shim kachivali kapingsai. Kala meiwui malei katha khangayeida athum kachivawui kachungli rasai. Kala athum kachiva Mangan Katharana kapingda ngatei tui khangayei hosa! Peterna ngakarangda hosa: Israel miwung, tui hi ngashonlu: Nazarethwui Jesu hili Varivarana thikahaiwui ngachaili thingkashangsai; chiwui maramli ithum kachiva sakhibing thotsai. Ningzan ngashunlu, kala nithum kachiva Jesu Christawui minli baptisma sayanlu!

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them. And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues. Then Peter stood up and said, Ye men of Israel, hear these words; This Jesus hath God raised up, whereof we all are witnesses. Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ.

Chapter 2 (Continued)

CHAPTER 2: READING CONTINUATION (PAGE 8)

TANGKHUL TEXT (CONTINUED):

Pentecost kumshang phungphatli nithum pam akhangli zikahai pamsai. Kazingwui huchiphung majung katha khara rasai, kala athum pamsahai shim kachivali kapingsai. Kala meiwui malei katha khangayeida athum kachivawui kachungli rasai. Kala athum kachiva Mangan Katharana kapingda ngatei tui khangayei hosa! Peterna ngakarangda hosa: Israel miwung, tui hi ngashonlu: Nazarethwui Jesu hili Varivarana thikahaiwui ngachaili thingkashangsai; chiwui maramli ithum kachiva sakhibing thotsai. Ningzan ngashunlu, kala nithum kachiva Jesu Christawui minli baptisma sayanlu!

ENGLISH TRANSLATION (CONTINUED):

And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them. And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues. Then Peter stood up and said, Ye men of Israel, hear these words; This Jesus hath God raised up, whereof we all are witnesses. Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ.

Chapter 2 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 2 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* Huchiphung (noun): rushing mighty wind, storm force
* Malei (noun): tongue, flame of speech
* Ngatei tui (noun phrase): other languages, diverse tongues
* Ningzan ngashun (verb phrase): to repent, rectify the mind and heart

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- The verbal phrase ’ningzan ngashunlu’ fuses ’ningzan’ (heart-contrition) with ’ngashun’ (to make straight).

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Describe the signs that accompanied the descent of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost.
? What did Peter urge the crowd to do at the conclusion of his sermon?

Chapter 3: Temple Gate wui Pamli Thotkhamatei (Lame Man at the Beautiful Gate)

CHAPTER 3: TEMPLE GATE WUI PAMLI THOTKHAMATEI (LAME MAN AT THE BEAUTIFUL GATE)

Summary: Healing of the lame man by Peter and John at the Beautiful Gate of the Temple.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Peter kala John thangkhamir pung chiko khangamor thangli Templeli zangvangasai. Phaphuk khazat akhat, awui phankahaiwui thotli theisai, aya Templewui Mathan Gate kahowali pamsai; aya Peter kala Johnli theida seisan khamor khanasai. Peterna hosa: Rupa kala sona iwui chungli mathai mana; kha ina phungli nali khamlikha: Nazarethwui Jesu Christawui minli ngakarangda zatlu! Kala ayana awui pangkasho pangda thingkasangsai; chitharan awui phakhur kala pharu pangmashan phungsai! Aya ngachor-da ngakarangsai kala zat-zangsai, Templeli zangda khangachor kala Varivarali mathankashei sasai.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Now Peter and John went up together into the temple at the hour of prayer, being the ninth hour. And a certain man lame from his mother’s womb was carried, whom they laid daily at the gate of the temple which is called Beautiful, to ask alms of them that entered into the temple. Then Peter said, Silver and gold have I none; but such as I have give I thee: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth rise up and walk. And he took him by the right hand, and lifted him up: and immediately his feet and ankle bones received strength. And he leaping up stood, and walked, and entered with them into the temple, walking, and leaping, and praising God.

Chapter 3 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 3 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* Phaphuk khazat (noun phrase): lame from birth, crippled in the feet
* Rupa kala sona (noun phrase): silver and gold
* Pangkasho pang (noun phrase): right hand
* Khangachor (verb participle): leaping, dancing with joyous vigor

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- The paired coordinate 'rupa kala sona' uses standard Loan-Assamese roots fully naturalized in colonial Tangkhul.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? At what hour did Peter and John go up to the Temple?
? What memorable response did Peter give when asked for alms?

Chapter 4: Councilwui Phungli Sakhi Chitheikahai (Before the Sanhedrin)

CHAPTER 4: COUNCILWUI PHUNGLI SAKHI CHITHEIKAHAI (BEFORE THE SANHEDRIN)

Summary: Peter and John arrested and questioned before the rulers, elders, and scribes of the Council.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Athumna Peter kala Johnli ngachaili pamsahai hosa: Khipawui pangmashan kala minli nithumna hi sakha? Peterna Mangan Katharana kapingda hosa: Miwungwui khararbing kala Israelwui Hangvabing, ngatei khipawui chunglikha haring kaphan mathailak mana; maramchilu kazing kaphungli miwungli khami ngatei min khikha mathai mana! Kha athumna Peter kala Johnna ngahanda hosa: Nithumwui tui ngashon-katha Varivarawui tui ngashon-katha khipana mashungkha nithum shanshilu! Maramchilu ithumna theikahai kala ngashokahai tui masasa pamtang mathailak mana.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

And when they had set them in the midst, they asked, By what power, or by what name, have ye done this? Then Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, said unto them, Ye rulers of the people, and elders of Israel, Neither is there salvation in any other: for there is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be saved. But Peter and John answered and said unto them, Whether it be right in the sight of God to hearken unto you more than unto God, judge ye. For we cannot but speak the things which we have seen and heard.

Chapter 4 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 4 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* Hangvabing (noun plural): council of elders, senators, Sanhedrin magistrates
* Kazing kaphungli (prepositional phrase): under heaven, beneath the celestial dome
* Ngashon-katha (verb phrase): to hearken, obey, submit to authority
* Shanshilu (imperative verb): judge ye, weigh and determine

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Pettigrew uses the indigenous administrative title 'Hangvabing' (village elder bench) for the Sanhedrin rulers.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? How did Peter respond to the council's prohibition against preaching?

? Explain the cultural borrowing of 'Hangva' in early Tangkhul scriptural translation.

Chapter 5: Stephenwui Pao kala Kashung Thot (The Martyrdom of Stephen)

CHAPTER 5: STEPHENWUI PAO KALA KASHUNG THOT (THE MARTYRDOM OF STEPHEN)

Summary: Stephen’s defense before the council, vision of the Son of Man, and stoning as the first Christian martyr.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Stephenna ning-kachang kala pangmashan phungda miwungwui ngachaili theichithei kaphung sasai. Council shimli pambing kachivana ali theida awui mai kazingram kachisowui mai katha theisai. Kha aya Mangan Katharana kapingda kazingli theida Varivarawui mathankashak theisai. Kala athumna lungna chidatli Stephenna khon-kaphung: O Mapao Jesu, iwui mangankhali khaphanlu! Kala aya phakhur phumda kaho: O Mapao, kakhama hi athumwui chungli machonlu! Hi hoda aya thikahaisai. Saulna awui thikahaili ningkachang phungsai.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

And Stephen, full of faith and power, did great wonders and miracles among the people. And all that sat in the council, looking stedfastly on him, saw his face as it had been the face of an angel. But he, being full of the Holy Ghost, looked up stedfastly into heaven, and saw the glory of God. And they stoned Stephen, calling upon God, and saying, Lord Jesus, receive my spirit. And he kneeled down, and cried with a loud voice, Lord, lay not this sin to their charge. And when he had said this, he fell asleep. And Saul was consenting unto his death.

Chapter 5 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 5 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* Lungna chidat (verb phrase): cast stones, stoned with rocks
* Khon-kaphung (verb participle): calling out with loud voice, invoking
* Machonlu (imperative negative): lay not to charge, impute not
* Phakhur phum (verb phrase): kneeled down, fell on knees in prayer

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Instrumental postposition ’-na’ on ’lungna’ marks the lethal physical instrument: by means of stones.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What two prayers did Stephen utter before his death?
? Who was recorded as consenting to Stephen’s death?

Chapter 6: Corneliusli Pao Kazang (Conversion of Cornelius)

CHAPTER 6: CORNELIUSLI PAO KAZANG (CONVERSION OF CORNELIUS)

Summary: Peter’s vision of the clean and unclean animals, journey to Caesarea, and the gospel opened to the Gentiles.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Caesarea ramli Cornelius kahona Italian cohortwui centurion akhat pamsai. Aya Varivarali kacharan, awui shim kachiva ngasoda, miwungli dori khami kala Varivarali thang kachiva khangamor. Peterna Caesareali rada hosa: Kaphung-kachangli ina theisai Varivarana mi akhatli kaching mei mana; kha ram kachivali Ali kacharan kala mashungkasa chi Awui ningkachang phungsai. Peterna tui hi holikha Mangan Katharana tui ngashonbing kachivawui chungli rasai!

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

There was a certain man in Caesarea called Cornelius, a centurion of the band called the Italian band, A devout man, and one that feared God with all his house, which gave much alms to the people, and prayed to God alway. Then Peter opened his mouth, and said, Of a truth I perceive that God is no respecter of persons: But in every nation he that feareth him, and worketh righteousness, is accepted with him. While Peter yet spake these words, the Holy Ghost fell on all them which heard the word.

Chapter 6 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 6 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* Kaching mei mana (idiomatic clause): does not show partiality, no respecter of persons
* Kacharan (adjective / verb): reverent, God-fearing, devout
* Dori (noun): alms, charitable offerings to the needy
* Ningkachang (noun): favor, delight, divine acceptance

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- The negative comparative 'kaching mei mana' (literally: does not exceed in biased viewing) translates impartial justice.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What was the occupation of Cornelius in Caesarea?

? What theological breakthrough did Peter announce in Acts 10:34-35?

Chapter 7: Athens Ramli Paulna Tui Chitheikahai (Paul at the Areopagus)

CHAPTER 7: ATHENS RAMLI PAULNA TUI CHITHEIKAHAI (PAUL AT THE AREOPAGUS)

Summary: Paul’s sermon at Mars Hill in Athens concerning the Unknown God, repentance, and resurrection.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Paulna Areopagus (Mars Hill) ngachaili ngakarangda hosa: Athens miwung,
ina theisai nithum thang kachiva kameo khangamor phungsai; maramchilu
ina zatli nithumwui altar akhatli kaphika theisai: MATHIKAHAI
VARIVARALI. Nithumna matheila khangamor hili ina chitheikhami! Kazing
kala ngalei kala chili leisatha kachiva sakahai Varivara chili kazing
kala ngaleiwui Mapaosai, Aya mina sakahai templeli mapam mana;
maramchilu Awui chungli ithum haring, zatta, kala pamsai; nithumwui la-
kashabingna hokatha: ’Ithumya Awui kachung thotsai.’

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Then Paul stood in the midst of Mars’ hill, and said, Ye men of Athens,
I perceive that in all things ye are too superstitious. For as I passed
by, and beheld your devotions, I found an altar with this inscription,
TO THE UNKNOWN GOD. Whom therefore ye ignorantly worship, him declare I
unto you. God that made the world and all things therein, seeing that he
is Lord of heaven and earth, dwelleth not in temples made with hands;
For in him we live, and move, and have our being; as certain also of
your own poets have said, For we are also his offspring.

Chapter 7 (Continued)

CHAPTER 7: READING CONTINUATION (PAGE 19)

TANGKHUL TEXT (CONTINUED):

Paulna Areopagus (Mars Hill) ngachaili ngakarangda hosa: Athens miwung,
ina theisai nithum thang kachiva kameo khangamor phungsai; maramchilu
ina zatli nithumwui altar akhatli kaphika theisai: MATHIKAHAI
VARIVARALI. Nithumna matheila khangamor hili ina chitheikhami! Kazing
kala ngalei kala chili leisatha kachiva sakahai Varivara chili kazing
kala ngaleiwui Mapaosai, Aya mina sakahai templeli mapam mana;
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your own poets have said, For we are also his offspring.

Chapter 7 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 7 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* Mathikahai Varivara (noun phrase): Unknown God, the unrevealed Creator
* Kameo (noun): traditional nature spirits, idols, lesser deities
* La-kashabing (noun plural): poets, ballad makers, lyricists
* Kachung (noun): offspring, lineage, children of the divine

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Pettigrew contrasts indigenous 'Kameo' (animistic spirits) with the sovereign 'Varivara' (Creator of heaven and earth).

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What inscription did Paul encounter in Athens?

? How did Paul quote the Greek poets in Tangkhul?

Comprehensive Vocabulary Glossary

COMPREHENSIVE BOOK GLOSSARY (TUIWON SHIYAN):

Kachatbing [noun plural]: apostles, authoritative emissaries
Pangmashan [noun]: power, divine might, spiritual authority
Sakhibing [noun plural]: witnesses, testifiers to truth
Theishak [noun]: lots, divine casting of decision
Huchiphung [noun]: rushing mighty wind, storm force
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